

ANKIT MEHTA | CEO | IDEAForge TECHNOLOGY

Qualcomm-backed ideaForge Technology is a Mumbai-based drone manufacturer



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PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

“Bring in experts to understand customers”

What was the problem you were grappling with?

We faced a challenge with the unpredictable nature of revenue, especially when dealing with defence and government clients. Despite our best efforts and resources dedicated to engaging with stakeholders and forecasting, accurately predicting key events such as contract awards, procurement orders, and revenue realisation remained elusive. This further led to disparities between anticipated and actual outcomes, which in turn affected our strategic planning and significantly impacted stakeholders' confidence.

Whom did you approach for advice and why?

With our limited experience in the domain back then, we sought advice from Nicholas Brathwaite (Nic), Founder and Managing Partner at Celesta Capital, and one of the nominee directors on our board, during a discussion. He has experience operating large hardware-oriented businesses.

What was the advice you received?

Nic emphasised the significance of onboarding individuals with substantial industry experience for essential roles. In addition, he also stressed the importance of leveraging the expertise of seasoned professionals to better comprehend customer behaviour and industry trends.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

Hiring and incorporating the expertise of seasoned professionals helped us better understand customer behaviour and develop refined processes for sales. This has greatly improved our capacity to forecast and handle revenue streams. This strategic shift empowered us to filter out extraneous noise, focus on high-value opportunities, and drive business growth with greater confidence and precision. Ultimately, this approach not only accelerated our learning curve but also enabled us to navigate the complexities of the industry with resilience and success. **BT**

—TEAM BT

Vol. 33, No. 7 for the fortnight
March 18, 2024 to March 31, 2024.
Released on March 18, 2024.

Total number of pages 132 (including cover)